WHEN THE QUR'AN CHANGES YOU

A Suhbah Session

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

إِنَّ الْحَمْدَ لِلَّهِ، نَحْمَدُهُ وَنَسْتَعِينُهُ وَنَسْتَغْفِرُهُ وَأَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ، وَأَشْهَدُ أَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا عَبْدُهُ وَرَسُولُهُ السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكُمْ وَرَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ وَبَرَكَاتُهُ

OPENING

I want to start tonight with a question.

Not about your relationship with the Qur'an. That comes later.

First — I want you to imagine a world without it.

Not just you personally without the Qur'an. A world where the Qur'an was never revealed. Islam does not exist. The name Muhammad ﷺ was never known on this earth.

Most of us felt something when we saw images of an empty Ka'bah during COVID. That hollow ache. The silence where there should have been adhān. The empty ṭawāf. It hurt in a way that was hard to explain.

But now imagine something far worse.

A Ka'bah surrounded by idols. No adhān. No Qur'an. No Islam. Anywhere. Not hidden or suppressed. Simply — never there.

That was the world before revelation.

And then Allah ﷻ spoke.

PART ONE: WHAT THE WORLD LOOKED LIKE WITHOUT REVELATION

The Prophet ﷺ described the state of that world in one sentence that should stop us cold:

ARABIC:

> نَظَرَ اللَّهُ إِلَى أَهْلِ الْأَرْضِ عَرَبِهِمْ وَعَجَمِهِمْ، فَمَقَتَهُمْ، إِلَّا بَقَايَا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْكِتَابِ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Nadhara Allahu ila ahli al-ardhi arabihim wa ajamihim, famaqatahum, illa baqaya min ahlil kitab."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"Allah looked at the people of the earth — Arabs and non-Arabs — and was repulsed by them. Except for a small remnant from the People of the Book."*

Repulsed. By the entire earth.

Every civilization. Every culture. Every kingdom. The full human landscape — and Allah ﷻ looked at it and turned away.

The world had lost its moral compass. Revelation had faded. Guidance had almost completely disappeared.

This is the wound the Qur'an came to heal.

And it changed everything it touched.

But tonight I want to show you not just what it did to the world — but what it did to one man. One specific man. Because his story is the clearest mirror we have of what the Qur'an is actually capable of doing to a human being.

PART TWO: THE MAN WITH NO CEILING

His name is **'Abdullāh ibn Mas'ūd رضي الله عنه.**

Before the Qur'an found him, he had:

No tribe. No wealth. No political backing. No family power. No social status. No protection.

He was a shepherd on the outskirts of Makkah, at the very bottom of a society where hierarchy was everything. In tribal Arabia, survival for someone like him meant staying invisible. Do not attract attention. Do not offend the wrong person. Earn enough. Move on.

That was his ceiling. Not even his dream — his ceiling. The highest he dared to imagine for himself.

And yet — Allah had a different plan for him.

PART THREE: THE ENCOUNTER IN THE VALLEY

One day, tending his sheep outside Makkah, two men passed by. He did not know who they were.

One of them — the Prophet ﷺ — asked for milk from one of the sheep.

Ibn Masʿūd's response tells you exactly who he already was, before transformation:

"I cannot give you any. I am entrusted with these animals. They are not mine."

He was **مُؤْتَمَن** — the trustworthy one. The one who keeps his word when no one is watching. When saying yes would have cost him nothing.

He said no — because the animals were not his to give.

The Prophet ﷺ asked for a dry goat. Ibn Masʿūd brought one.

The Prophet ﷺ placed his blessed hands on the udder and said:

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ

And milk began to flow.

Milk. From a dry goat. In an empty valley outside Makkah.

The Prophet ﷺ drank. He gave Abū Bakr رضي الله عنه. He gave Ibn Masʿūd.

And Ibn Masʿūd — this shepherd with no name and no tribe — stood there holding something impossible in his hands.

His response in that moment is everything.

He did not just stand there stunned. He did not just walk away with a story to tell.

He asked: *"Teach me the words you just said."*

The Prophet ﷺ wiped his chest and said:

إِنَّكَ غُلَامٌ مُعَلَّمٌ

"You are a teachable young man."

You are ready. Your heart is open. Your soil is prepared.

Whatever is planted in you — will grow.

PART FOUR: THE ONLY THING OF VALUE IN THE ENTIRE WORLD

Hold this scene in your mind.

A valley outside Makkah. No Islamic civilization. No Qur'an schools. No masjids. No institutions of any kind. Just a shepherd, a stranger, and a miracle.

At that exact moment in history, everything the world called valuable — wealth, lineage, power, influence, status — was present in the city a few miles away. The chiefs of Quraysh had it all.

And yet the most valuable thing happening on earth at that moment was in that empty valley.

The Prophet ﷺ had said:

ARABIC:

> **إِنَّ الدُّنْيَا مَلْعُونَةٌ، مَلْعُونٌ مَا فِيهَا، إِلَّا ذِكْرَ اللَّهِ وَمَا وَالَاهُ، أَوْ عَالِمًا أَوْ مُتَعَلِّمًا**

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Innad dunya mal'oona, mal'oonun maa feeha, illa dhikrallahi wa maa waalah, aw aaliman aw muta'allima."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"The world is cursed, and everything in it is cursed — except the remembrance of Allah and what surrounds it, or a scholar or a student."*

In that valley there was:

- The remembrance of Allah — **بِسْمِ اللَّهِ**
- The greatest teacher — Muhammad ﷺ
- A sincere student — Ibn Masʿūd رضي الله عنه

That is it. That small, quiet, unwitnessed moment — between a shepherd and a stranger in a valley that no one else saw.

And it is still reaching us today, 1,400 years later.

Everything else from that era is gone. The idols of Quraysh are dust. Their chiefs are forgotten. Their palaces do not exist.

But that valley — that moment of **مُعَلِّم** and **مُتَعَلِّم** — is still alive. Still teaching. Still

transforming.

That is what the Qur'an does. It outlives everything it touches.

PART FIVE: THE WEIGHT OF THIS BOOK

Before we go further — I want you to feel something.

Not intellectually understand. Feel.

Allah ﷻ says in the Qur'an:

ARABIC:

> لَوْ أَنزَلْنَا هَٰذَا الْقُرْآنَ عَلَىٰ جَبَلٍ لَّرَأَيْتَهُ خَاشِعًا مُّتَصَدِّعًا مِّنْ خَشْيَةِ اللَّهِ ۚ وَتِلْكَ الْأَمْثَالُ نَضْرِبُهَا لِلنَّاسِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Law anzalnaa haadhal Qur'aana 'alaa jabalin lara'aytahu khaashi'an mutasaddi'an min khashyatillah. Wa tilkal amthaalu nadribuhaa linnaasi la'allahum yatafakkaroon."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"If We had sent down this Qur'an upon a mountain, you would have seen it humbled and splitting apart from the fear of Allah. And these are the examples We present to the people — that perhaps they will reflect."* — Surah Al-Hashr (59:21)

A mountain.

Not a small hill. A mountain — something that has stood for millions of years, something that makes human beings feel small just by looking at it — would be split apart and crumbled into dust by the weight of these words.

And we hold this Book in our hands and feel nothing.

Not because the Book is less than it is. But because the mountain was more present than we are.

The mountain would respond to what we have grown numb to.

This verse is not just a description. It is a question directed at every one of us:

If a mountain would shatter — what is this Book doing to you?

PART SIX: THE MOMENT OF DECISION

Back to Ibn Masʿūd.

He had an extraordinary experience. He witnessed a miracle. He was told by the Prophet ﷺ himself: you are ready to receive.

And then — he had to choose.

He could have said: *"That was remarkable. I will see what develops before I commit."*

He could have returned to his sheep and told himself: *"I will think about it."*

If he had done that — history would not know his name. Not one person in this room would be talking about him tonight.

But he ran.

This shepherd — short, dark-skinned, with no tribe and no protection, with every reason the world had ever given him to stay small — ran toward the Prophet ﷺ and chose to become a student.

And this is the pattern of every transformation in Islamic history.

The heart opens — and then the person acts. Not tomorrow. Not after things settle down. Not when the timing is better.

Now.

ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb رضي الله عنه heard the Qurʾan being recited in his sister's house and was stopped in his tracks. If he had said: *"I am moved — I need to process this"* — he would not be the ʿUmar we love today.

Transformation does not wait for a convenient moment. The moment is always now — and it always asks you to run.

PART SEVEN: FROM SHEPHERD TO QUR'AN GIANT

Look at what this man became.

He later said himself:

"I took seventy sūrahs directly from the mouth of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ."

Seventy sūrahs. Received directly — from the lips of the one they were revealed upon.

The Qur'an would descend upon the heart of the Prophet ﷺ. Leave his blessed lips. And enter directly into the heart of Ibn Masʿūd.

And what it produced in him was so pure, so alive, so fragrant with closeness to Allah — that the Prophet ﷺ himself said:

ARABIC:

> مَنْ أَرَادَ أَنْ يَسْمَعَ الْقُرْآنَ غَضًّا كَمَا أُنْزِلَ، فَلْيَسْمَعْهُ مِنِ ابْنِ أُمِّ عَبْدٍ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Man araada an yasma'al Qur'aana ghaddhan kama unzila, falyasma'hu min ibni ummi 'abd."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"Whoever wishes to hear the Qur'an fresh — exactly as it was revealed — let him hear it from Ibn Umm 'Abd."*

Ibn Umm ʿAbd is Ibn Masʿūd.

The Prophet ﷺ is pointing people toward a shepherd from Makkah and saying: if you want to hear what this Qur'an sounded like when Jibrīl brought it — go to him.

And then one day the Prophet ﷺ said to Ibn Masʿūd:

"Recite the Qur'an to me."

Ibn Masʿūd was stunned. He said:

"Should I recite to you — when it was revealed upon you?"

The Prophet ﷺ said: *"I love to hear it from someone else."*

He had absorbed it so completely — it had changed him so deeply — that his recitation resembled the way Jibrīl himself had brought it down.

This is not memorization. This is not performance. This is not a certificate.

This is what happens when the Qur'an does not just enter your ears but changes who you are.

This is transformation.

PART EIGHT: INPUT AND OUTPUT

Every parable the Prophet ﷺ gave about the Qur'an follows the same pattern:

Input → Transformation → Output

He ﷺ said the believer who recites Qur'an is like a citrus fruit — beautiful smell, beautiful taste. Good inside, beautiful outside.

He ﷺ described the believing heart as fertile land. Rain falls. It absorbs. And then it produces gardens that everyone around benefits from.

That is what happened to Ibn Masʿūd. He absorbed the Qur'an until it came back out of him — purified, alive, fragrant — and entire cities were transformed by what he had absorbed.

The question tonight is not whether the Qur'an is capable of doing this to you.

It split mountains in the words of Allah Himself.

The question is whether you are willing to be changed. Whether you will come to it as fertile ground — or as concrete, where the rain falls and runs straight off leaving nothing behind.

PART NINE: THE FIRST PUBLIC RECITATION

Now imagine the scene.

The Ḥaram in Makkah. The Ka'bah surrounded by idols. The Qur'an considered the most dangerous, most offensive message to the Quraysh. The Prophet ﷺ had companions from noble families — men with tribal protection, men with names that carried weight.

None of them stepped forward first.

The first person to publicly recite the Qur'an inside the Ḥaram was not a protected nobleman.

It was the shepherd with no tribe.

ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd stood in front of the Ka'bah — the same Ka'bah that was surrounded by idols — and he recited:

ARABIC:

> الرَّحْمَٰنُ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Ar-Rahmaan. 'Allamal Qur'aan. Khalaqal insaan. 'Allamahul bayaan."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him expression."* — Surah Ar-Rahman (55:1-4)

He recited with the same purity with which it had descended.

They attacked him. Stomped on him. Beat him. Broke his collarbone. They punched him and kicked him until he could not stand.

And when he finally rose — bloodied, battered, alone — do you know what he said?

"The enemies of Allah are more contemptible in my eyes than they were before."

Not bitterness. Not defeat. Contempt for what had tried to silence the word of Allah.

The man they tried to silence became the foundation of an entire civilisation of Qur'anic knowledge.

The very place where they beat him for reciting — that same Ḥaram — now never stops reciting. Every second of every day, in every language on earth, the Qur'an is recited inside it.

They lost. And the Qur'an won.

It always wins.

PART TEN: THIRTY-TWO YEARS LATER

Thirty-two years after that beating.

ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb رضي الله عنه — now Caliph of the entire Muslim world — sends Ibn Masʿūd to Kūfah in Iraq.

His message to the people of Kūfah:

"I have preferred you over myself by sending you ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd. It pains me to part with him because of how much I love him."

The most powerful man in the Muslim world is saying: I am giving you something precious to me.

Kūfah became a centre of Qur'anic knowledge unlike almost anything that existed. And the most widely recited Qur'anic recitation in the world today:

Ḥafṣ ʿan ʿĀṣim al-Kūfī

Traces back to that city. And that city traces back to Ibn Masʿūd.

He went from **مُتَعَلِّم** — student — to **مُعَلِّم** — teacher.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

ARABIC:

> **خَيْرُكُمْ مَنْ تَعَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ وَعَلَّمَهُ**

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Khayrukum man ta'allamal Qur'aana wa 'allamah."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"The best of you are those who learn the Qur'an and teach it."*

Not the most impressive. Not the loudest. Not the one with the most followers.

The one who absorbed it — and passed it on.

PART ELEVEN: WHEN A SOCIETY THINKS IN QUR'AN

Kūfah became so immersed in the Qur'an that something beautiful began to happen to its people.

A group from Kūfah once traveled to Madinah. 'Umar رضي الله عنه met them and began asking questions — casually, naturally.

He asked:

مِنْ أَيْنَ أَقْبَلْتُمْ؟ *"Where are you coming from?"*

They replied with an āyah — without thinking, without preparing, without performing:

ARABIC:

> **مِن فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ**

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Min fajjin 'ameeq."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"From a deep valley."* — Surah Al-Hajj (22:27)

He asked:

أَيْنَ تُرِيدُونَ؟ *"Where are you going?"*

They replied:

ARABIC:

> إِلَى الْبَيْتِ الْعَتِيقِ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *“Ilal baytil ’ateeq.”*

TRANSLATION:

> *“To the Ancient House.”* — Surah Al-Hajj (22:29)

ʿUmar turned to those around him and said:

“They have a scholar among them.”

Just from those two replies.

He continued:

مَا أَعْظَمُ سُورَةٍ فِي الْقُرْآنِ؟ *“What is the greatest sūrah in the Qur’an?”*

قَالُوا: الْفَاتِحَة *They said: Al-Fātiḥah.*

مَا أَعْظَمُ آيَةٍ فِي الْقُرْآنِ؟ *“What is the greatest āyah in the Qur’an?”*

قَالُوا: آيَةُ الْكُرْسِيِّ *They said: Āyat al-Kursī.*

مَا أَرْجَى آيَةٍ فِي الْقُرْآنِ؟ *“What is the most hopeful verse in the Qur’an?”*

They answered:

ARABIC:

> قُلْ يَا عِبَادِيَ الَّذِينَ أَسْرَفُوا عَلَىٰ أَنفُسِهِمْ لَا تَقْنَطُوا مِن رَّحْمَةِ اللَّهِ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *“Qul yaa ’ibaadiyalladheena asrafoo ’alaa anfusihim laa taqnatoo min rahmatillah.”*

TRANSLATION:

> *“Say: O My servants who have transgressed against themselves — do not despair of the mercy of Allah.”* — Surah Az-Zumar (39:53)

At the end of the conversation, ʿUmar asked:

أَفِيكُمْ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ مَسْعُودٍ؟

“Is ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd among you?”

They said: Yes.

He nodded. That explained everything.

This is the deepest kind of influence. Not followers on a platform. Not viral content. Not a large audience.

People who absorbed the Book so completely that it became the language of their thinking — naturally, effortlessly — because it was simply who they were.

The Qur'an had entered them and reorganised everything inside.

PART TWELVE: THE WARNING

But Ibn Mas'ūd رضي الله عنه also gave a warning. A warning that feels like it was written for us specifically.

He said about the end of times:

ARABIC:

> كَثْرَةُ الْقُرَّاءِ وَقِلَّةُ الْفُقَهَاءِ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Kathratun qurraa'i wa qillatul fuqahaa'."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"An abundance of reciters — and a scarcity of those who truly understand."*

People will recite. Beautifully. Constantly. Competitively.

But it will not penetrate. It will not move from the tongue to the heart. It will not transform.

Because it never moved from heart to heart.

When the sincere teacher disappears — and the sincere student disappears — the Qur'an becomes background noise. And once it becomes noise — it stops transforming.

And if it stops transforming — we return to what the world was before revelation. In our hearts at least. Dark. Hollow. Purposeless.

This is the warning. And it is urgent.

PART THIRTEEN: THE BANQUET YOU KEEP IGNORING

Ibn Masʿūd رضي الله عنه described the Qur'an using words that should shake us:

ARABIC:

> إِنَّ هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ مَأْدُبَةُ اللَّهِ

TRANSLATION:

> *"This Qur'an is the banquet of Allah."*

Think about what that means.

A banquet is not survival rations. It is not the minimum you need to stay alive. It is honored provision — prepared with care, presented with generosity — and you have been personally invited.

Allah جَلَّ جَلَالُهُ has spread a table for you. Every single day. He has prepared something for you — specifically for you — in His Book. And He is waiting.

Ibn Masʿūd said: fill yourselves with it. Busy yourselves with it. Take advantage of it.

Because hearts are vessels. And empty vessels do not stay empty.

If you do not fill your heart with revelation — it will fill itself with distraction. With anxiety. With whatever noise the world sends in its direction. And it fills fast, and it fills quietly, and you often do not notice until you sit down one day and try to feel something real — and realize there is no space left.

The Prophet ﷺ said:

ARABIC:

> إِنَّ الْبَيْتَ الَّذِي لَا شَيْءَ فِيهِ مِنَ الْقُرْآنِ كَالْبَيْتِ الْخَرِبِ

TRANSLITERATION:

> *"Innal baytalldhee laa shay'a feehi minal Qur'aani kaal baytil kharib."*

TRANSLATION:

> *"The house that contains nothing of the Qur'an is like a ruined home."*

A ruined house is dark. Unstable. Exposed to everything from the outside. No walls that hold. No roof that protects. Just rubble where there should be a home.

Now extend that image.

A heart without Qur'an — a ruined home. A family without Qur'an — a ruined household. A

community without Qur'an — a ruined civilisation.

And it begins with one heart. Right now. Tonight.

PART FOURTEEN: THE GARDENS OF IBN MAS'ŪD

He spoke about a section of the Qur'an called **Āl Ḥā Mīm** — the seven Meccan sūrahs beginning with حٰمٓ — sūrahs of Tawḥīd, the Hereafter, divine majesty. No legal rulings. Just pure, direct confrontation with the reality of who Allah is and who we are.

And he said:

ARABIC:

> إِذَا دَخَلْتُ فِي آلِ حَمِيمٍ فَكَأَنَّنِي فِي رَوْضَاتٍ أَتَنَدَّقُ فِيهِنَّ

TRANSLATION:

> *"When I enter into Āl Ḥā Mīm, it is as though I am strolling through lush gardens."*

He did not say: I analyze them. I understand their structure. I have memorized them.

He said: **I stroll through them.**

With joy. With ease. With the unhurried peace of someone who belongs where they are.

When he heard حٰمٓ — something in his chest woke up.

This is what a real relationship with the Qur'an looks like. Not a duty. Not a quota. Not a performance.

A garden you return to because something in you comes alive there that stays quiet everywhere else.

Some of you will feel that with Sūrat Yūsuf. Others with Sūrat Maryam. Others with Sūrat Ar-Rahmān. There is a passage — somewhere in this Book — that was placed there for your heart specifically. A verse that, when you read it at the right moment, feels like it was written the night before and slipped between the pages before you opened them.

Find it. Return to it. Let it become your garden.

What is your رَوْضَة — your garden in the Qur'an?

PART FIFTEEN: READ IT LIKE IT'S THE FIRST TIME

The early generations read the Qurʼan with three convictions:

It was revealed yesterday — not 1,400 years ago. It was addressed directly to them — not to someone else. It might be the last time they ever read it.

Not new rulings. Not new creed. But new humility, new realization, new tears — every single time they came to it.

If you grew up with the Qurʼan — that is a gift beyond measure. But inherited wealth does not feel like earned wealth. At some point you have to approach the Qurʼan:

Alone. Without your parents. Without your environment. Without the routine that has made it familiar and therefore invisible.

You must choose it — for yourself.

The way Ibn Masʿūd chose it. In a valley with nothing. When it cost him everything.

PART SIXTEEN: THE HONEST CONVERSATION

Let me be direct with you.

Some of you will leave tonight and open the Qurʼan. And you will read a page and feel nothing. And you will close it and think: this does not work for me.

And I want to say this clearly.

You cannot sit in silence, away from your phone, and read the Qurʼan with sincere intention — and genuinely feel nothing. It is not possible. This is the Book that Allah says would shatter a mountain.

If you feel nothing — it is not the Qurʼan. It is the noise. It is the overstimulation. It is the autopilot that has settled over your heart like dust over a surface that has not been touched in a while.

Think about what happens in ṣalāh:

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ

Your brain finished it before you consciously started. Neural pathway. Done.

اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ، لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ، وَلَمْ يَكُن لَّهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ

Autopilot. The tongue moved. The heart was somewhere else.

And these are the words that — if a mountain could hear them — would split it open.

So disrupt the pattern. Read a sūrah you have never recited in ṣalāh. Slow down until it feels uncomfortable. Read one āyah — and sit with it until you actually feel the weight of what Allah is saying to you through it.

Force your heart to stop recognising and start listening.

PART SEVENTEEN: APPROACH IT WANTING TO CHANGE

Most of us approach the Qur'an wanting comfort. Wanting soothing. Wanting a spiritual feeling that makes us okay with where we are.

And when we get that — we close the Book unchanged.

But that is not what this is.

The Qur'an is not background therapy. It is not decoration for your Islamic aesthetic. It does not exist to make you feel good about yourself as you are.

It is surgery.

It is designed to go inside you and remove what does not belong there. And sometimes what it removes is something you were attached to. And that process is not always comfortable. And that is the point.

There is something about Qur'anic recitation that moves the human soul in a way nothing else does. People of other faiths have admitted this. People who do not believe in Islam have sat and wept listening to it without understanding a word.

Because this is not poetry. Not performance. Not human speech.

This is **كَلَامُ اللَّهِ** — the speech of Allah ﷻ.

And if you give it space — real space, not five distracted minutes before sleep — it will reach something in you that nothing else in this world has been able to reach.

PART EIGHTEEN: THE WORD THAT CHANGES EVERYTHING

At the center of every transformation this Book produces — is one statement:

لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ، مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ

We say it so often it has become sound without meaning.

But sit with what it is actually saying.

لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ

There is nothing worthy of your ultimate devotion except Allah.

Nothing else deserves your complete surrender. Nothing else can sustain you. Nothing else is worth building your entire identity upon.

Not your grades. Not your career. Not your appearance. Not the opinions of people who will forget your name in ten years. Not your fears. Not your longing for belonging.

Nothing. Except Allah.

And then:

مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ

This path is not self-designed. It is guided. Modeled. Embodied. You are not trying to figure life out alone. The way has been shown.

For people who have spent their lives moving from one source of meaning to another — each one eventually collapsing — this statement is:

Clarity after chaos. Ground beneath feet that have been searching for solid earth. Arrival after a very long, exhausting search.

Simple words. Revolutionary meaning.

This is what the Qurʼan came to establish in every heart it entered.

And it is waiting to establish it in yours.

CLOSING

The call tonight is simple.

Sit with the Qurʼan — until you can speak about it the way Ibn Masʿūd رضي الله عنه spoke about it. Until you have found your garden. Until there is a verse that disrupts you and a sūrah that wakes something up inside you.

Ask yourself:

Which āyah feels like it was written for exactly where you are right now?

Which passage — when you read it slowly and alone — makes you want to be better?

Which verse, if you truly lived by it, would change the next year of your life?

Because if you approach the Qur'an ready to be changed — it will change you.

It changed a shepherd with no tribe, no wealth, and no name into a man whose recitation the Prophet ﷺ pointed people toward. A man whose influence built cities. A man whose voice is still reaching us — through chains of transmission that have never broken — 1,400 years later.

If it could do that to him — with nothing — imagine what it can do to you.

You just have to open it like you mean it.

THE DUʿĀʾ

اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْنَا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْقُرْآنِ

"O Allah — make us from the people of the Qur'an."

اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْ قُلُوبَنَا أَوْعِيَةً صَالِحَةً لِكَلَامِكَ

"O Allah — make our hearts worthy vessels for Your speech."

وَاجْعَلْنَا حَمَلَةً صَالِحِينَ لِهٰذَا الْقُرْآنِ وَلِهٰذَا الدِّينِ

"And make us worthy carriers of this Qur'an and this religion."

اللَّهُمَّ آمِينَ

وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ وَسَلَّمَ وَبَارَكَ عَلَىٰ نَبِيِّنَا مُحَمَّدٍ، وَعَلَىٰ آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ

السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكُمْ وَرَحْمَةُ اللَّهِ وَبَرَكَاتُهُ

QUICK REFERENCE — ALL ARABIC TEXTS

Reference	Arabic Opening	Context
Hadith — Allah looked at the earth	نَظَرَ اللَّهُ إِلَى أَهْلِ الْأَرْضِ	State of the world before revelation
Hadith — The world is cursed	إِنَّ الدُّنْيَا مَلْعُونَةٌ	Only dhikr, scholar, and student have value
Hadith — Teachable young man	إِنَّكَ غُلَامٌ مُعَلَّمٌ	Prophet ﷺ to Ibn Masʿūd

Surah Al-Hashr 59:21	لَوْ أَنزَلْنَا هَٰذَا الْقُرْآنَ عَلَىٰ جَبَلٍ	If the Qur’an were placed on a mountain
Hadith — Hear Qur’an as revealed	مَنْ أَرَادَ أَنْ يَسْمَعَ الْقُرْآنَ	Prophet ﷺ directing people to Ibn Mas‘ūd
Surah Ar-Rahman 55:1-4	الرَّحْمَٰنُ، عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ	First public recitation in the Haram
Hadith — Best of you	خَيْرُكُمْ مَنْ تَعَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ	Learn and teach
Conversation — From a deep valley	مِنْ فَجٍّ عَمِيقٍ	Al-Hajj 22:27 — people of Kūfah
Conversation — To the Ancient House	إِلَى الْبَيْتِ الْعَتِيقِ	Al-Hajj 22:29 — people of Kūfah
Conversation — ‘Umar’s question	أَفِيكُمْ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ مَسْعُودٍ	The recognition of Ibn Mas‘ūd’s influence
Surah Az-Zumar 39:53	قُلْ يَا عِبَادِيَ	Most hopeful verse — do not despair
Athar — Ibn Mas‘ūd’s warning	كَثْرَةُ الْقُرَّاءِ وَقِلَّةُ الْفُقَهَاءِ	Reciters without understanding
Athar — The banquet of Allah	إِنَّ هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ مَأْدُبَةُ اللَّهِ	Qur’an as honored provision
Hadith — The ruined house	إِنَّ الْبَيْتَ الَّذِي لَا شَيْءَ	Home without Qur’an is a ruined home
Athar — Strolling through gardens	إِذَا دَخَلْتُ فِي آلِ حَمِيمٍ	Ibn Mas‘ūd’s personal connection
Shahada	لَا إِلٰهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ	The revolutionary statement
Dua — People of the Qur’an	اللَّهُمَّ اجْعَلْنَا مِنْ أَهْلِ الْقُرْآنِ	Closing supplication